

The 5-Minute IA Video: A Practical Guide



The 5-minute video is a critical part of your IA, providing the primary evidence for Criterion D. Its sole purpose is to demonstrate that your product is fully functional and to show examples of your testing strategy. It is not a presentation or a code walkthrough. This guide explains exactly what you must show (and what to leave out) to secure full marks for your product's functionality.

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The IA video is a new and often-confusing component, but its purpose is very specific. It is **not** a sales pitch, a presentation, or a code walkthrough.

Its *only* purpose is to provide direct evidence for **Criterion D (Functionality)** and **Criterion D/E (Testing)**.

The Strict Limits

- **Length: 5 minutes maximum.** If your video is longer, the moderator may not watch the rest. The TSM (p. 70) is clear that you cannot speed up the video just to fit more content in.
- **Format:** A common, easily-playable file format (e.g. **MP4**).
- **Size:** Aim to keep it under 500 MB for easy uploading.

What You MUST Show

Your video must clearly demonstrate two things:

1. Full Functionality

You must show a **single, continuous test run** of your product that demonstrates all the main features you built. This is your proof that your product works as described in your documentation.

2. Examples of Your Testing Strategy

This is the most-missed step. You must *also* show specific examples of your testing.

Show It Breaking!

- Don't just show your product working perfectly.
- The best videos show what happens when the user does something wrong.
- **Show yourself entering INVALID data** (like "abc" in a number field).
- **Show yourself entering EXTREME data** (like a 0 or a very large number).
- Showing your product handling these errors gracefully (e.g., "Invalid input, please try again") is the *best* way to prove your testing was effective.

What NOT to Include

Including these things wastes valuable time and will not get you any marks:

- **Your Face:** This is a screen recording, not a video of you.
- **Your Voice:** You *can* use your voice for commentary, but simple on-screen text or annotations explaining what you are doing is just as effective (and sometimes clearer).
- **Explanations of Your Code:** All code, algorithms, and justifications belong in your **Criterion D documentation**. The video is only for showing the *product*.
- **Lengthy Data Entry:** You *are* allowed to speed up the video *only* for moments of long, repetitive typing.

Tips for a Successful Video

1. **Plan It First:** Don't just hit record. Write a simple storyboard or a checklist of features you need to show in order. This ensures you don't miss anything.
2. **Use Screen Recording Software:** Use any standard screen recorder (e.g., OBS Studio, QuickTime, a built-in Windows tool).
3. **Use Simple Commentary:** As you perform an action, use on-screen text or a quiet voice-over.
 1. e.g., *"Now demonstrating the search function..."*
 2. e.g., *"Now testing invalid input for 'quantity' field..."*
4. **Edit for Clarity:** Use basic editing to make the video clearer. You can speed up slow parts (like data entry), add on-screen text or annotations to highlight features, and cut out mistakes or long pauses.
 1. **On Mac:** The built-in **iMovie** is perfect for this.
 2. **On Windows:** You can use the built-in **Clipchamp** (on Windows 11) or a free tool like **OpenShot**.
5. **Practice:** Do a few practice runs to make sure you can show everything within the 5-minute limit without rushing.

in your account being blocked and legal action being taken against you.

 **Report a problem**